Maritime Security Working Group similarly met in the US to take more practical steps, even as the IPMDA started to take shape.

On multilateralism, the Quad supported for the first time the Inter-Governmental Negotiations (IGN) process on Security Council reforms. It agreed to address attempts to subvert the UN and international system and to take forward the 2030 Agenda for SDG without prioritizing a narrow set of goals.

A different cluster of issues illustrate the contribution that the Quad can make to keep the world and itself safer, secure and protected. On counter-terrorism, starting with policy exchanges and experience sharing, the potential for mutual benefit was rapidly explored. A working group was established even as the focus on the use of emerging and evolving technologies in terrorism sharpened. Cyber security is also evolving as a productive arena of work. Sharing model approaches, encouraging development of talent, ensuring supply chain resilience and security and networking industries are its prominent facets.

The objective of the Quad, in the words of PM Modi, is to do global good. The need for that to be a collaborative effort is self-evident. It is equally natural that nations with significant capacities and shared interests would step forward in response to the need of the day. That India should be one of them makes sense, given how much it has grown on both scores. Indeed, its presence imbues the Quad with greater credibility because it does not carry a history of alliances. But for this to happen through partnerships with the three Quad countries was not always a given.

It can unfold today because painstaking efforts were made over many years to strengthen the bilateral relationships, which are the real building blocks. But even that, by itself, was not adequate. It took considerable openness of mind in all the Quad leaderships to envisage collaboration in a more contemporary manner.

Indeed, the Quad is proof that PM Modi walked the talk in declaring his intention to overcome hesitations of history. Similarly, the other three nations took a leap of faith beyond the orthodoxies of alliances. Since 2017, practical progress has validated the relevance of this sensible approach.

If the Quad is to continue growing, we must also be cognizant of what we should not seek to do. Trying to straitjacket it, subject it to stress tests or impose congruence over convergence are all harmful, not helpful. The Quad works precisely because it is flexible and understanding, a welcome